

MIT-PE Applied AI & Data Science Program (AAIDSP)

Capstone Project Briefing Session - January'26 cohorts

Capstone Project Objectives

- Experience end-to-end problem-solving using a combination of tools and techniques in machine learning
- Learn practical implementation of various analytical techniques and choose the one which gives results most appropriate for business
- To understand the trade-offs that need to be made when solving a problem in real life
- To develop better presentation and report writing skills

Capstone Projects

01

UNSUPERVISED LEARNING

(Data Analysis & Visualization)

03

CLASSIFICATION

(Practical Data Science)

05

RECOMMENDATION SYSTEMS

(Recommendation Systems)

02

REGRESSION

(Machine Learning)

04

DEEP LEARNING

(Malaria Detection & Facial
Emotion Detection)

06

GENERATIVE AI

(Generative AI)

Capstone Projects Stages



Low-Code vs Full-Code

Submission Type	Who should choose?	What is the same across the two?	What is different across the two?	Final submission file [IMP]	Submission format
Low-Code	Learners who aspire to be in managerial roles in the future focused on solution review, interpretation, recommendations & communicating with business	Perform exploratory data analysis to identify insights & recommendations for the problem	Focus on business report: 10-20% grading on the quality of the final business report submitted	Business report in .pdf format with problem definition, insights, and recommendations	.pdf
Full-Code	Learners who aspire to be in hands-on coding roles in the future focused on building solution codes from scratch		Focus on code writing: 10-20% grading on the quality of the final code submitted	Solution notebook from the full-code template submitted in .html format	.html

Submission

Full Code Version:

The full code way is to write the solution code from scratch and only submit a final Jupyter notebook in .html format with all the insights and observations.

Please follow the below steps to complete the submission:

- Download the full-code version of the learner notebook
- Follow the instructions provided in the notebook to complete the project
- Clearly write down insights and recommendations for the business problems in the comments
- Submit only the solution notebook prepared from the learner notebook [format - HTML]

Submission

Low Code Version:

The low-code way is to use an existing solution notebook template to build the solution and then submit a Business Report in .pdf format with insights and recommendations.

Please follow the below steps to complete the submission:

- Download the low-code version of the learner notebook
- Follow the instructions provided in the notebook to complete the project
- Prepare a Business Report with insights and recommendations to the business problem
- Submit only the presentation [format: PDF]

Kindly note that if you submit the notebook along with the report, **ONLY** the report will be evaluated

Milestone

1. Problem Definition:

- The context - Why is this problem important to solve?
- The objectives - What is the intended goal?
- The key questions - What are the key questions that need to be answered?
- The problem formulation - What is it that we are trying to solve using data science?

2. Data Exploration:

- Data Description - What is the background of this data? What does it contain?
- Observations & Insights - What are some key patterns in the data? What does it mean for the problem formulation? What are the data treatments or pre-processing performed?

3. Building various models:

- This involves constructing multiple relevant models to solve the problem and evaluating their performance. The models can be fine-tuned to determine whether their performance can be improved.

4. Comparison of various techniques and their relative performance:

- How do different techniques perform? Which one is performing relatively better? Is there scope to improve the performance further?

5. Proposal for the final solution design:

- What model do you propose to be adopted? Why is this the best solution to adopt?

Milestone Scoring

Criteria	Points
Problem Definition	4 points
Data Exploration	4 points
Building Models	4 points
Comparison of various techniques and their relative performance based on chosen Metric (Measure of success)	4 points
Proposal for the final solution design	4 points
Total Points	20 points

Final Submission

The Final Submission should focus on the key takeaways from the project. This is the final proposal to solve the problem that a business leader or a decision-maker should consume. This Final Submission should have three key parts:

1. Executive Summary

- What are the most important findings from the analysis done in Milestone?
- Describe the final proposed model specifications

2. Problem and solution summary

- Provide the summary of the problem
- State the reasons for the proposed solution design
- How it would affect the problem/business?

3. Recommendations for implementation

- What are some key recommendations to implement the solution?
- What are the key actionables for stakeholders?
- What is the expected benefit and/or costs (List the benefits of the solution. State some rational assumptions to put forward some numbers on costs/benefits for stakeholders)?
- What are the potential risks or challenges of the proposed solution design?
- What further analysis needs to be done or what other associated problems need to be solved?

Final Submission Scoring

Criteria	Points
Executive Summary	15 points
Problem and Solution Summary	10 points
Recommendations for Implementation	15 points
Total Points	40 points

Live Presentation

- This is the final stage of the Capstone journey, where learners are supposed to present their solution to a panelist for 8-9 minutes and then answer the questions in the next 4-5 minutes.
- The objective should be to draw the audience's attention to the key points of your project - problem definition, solution design, key findings/insights, and business recommendations.

Important Points:

- Structure the presentation well
- Learners will be given 8-9 minutes to present
- This will be followed by 4-5 minutes of question & answer
- Learners are expected to focus on explaining the takeaways
- The final presentation slide deck should be submitted before the session
- The final roster will be shared via email and Slack by April 8th, 2026 and no changes will be made to the schedule.
- To be eligible for the Live Presentations, learners must submit all deliverables: 9 Quiz Assessments, the Food Hub Project, the Elective Project Assessment, the Milestone Submission, the Final Submission, and the Presentation slide deck.

Live Presentation Scoring

Criteria	Points
Quality of Slides - Structure, flow and neatness	10 points
Understanding of the Solution - Ability to explain concepts	15 points
Depth of Analysis - Methodology & Rigour	15 points
Total Points	40 points

Support System

Role of a Mentor

What to Expect: During the Milestone & Capstone Q&A session, a mentor is a guide who will enable you to achieve your project outcomes.

- Consultant: Share his/her own industry experience and provide direction with his/her expertise.
- Guru/Mentor: Provide knowledge, hacks, insights, guidance, identify resources to learn, and stay updated.
- Leader: Motivate and build confidence, offer encouragement, and help you move out of your comfort zone.

What NOT to Expect: The mentor will not provide feedback or solutions to the project questions

Other Support Channels:

1. Slack Channels
2. GLAide (AI Mentor)
3. Support Tickets
4. FAQ Document
5. Program Manager

Capstone Submission Format & Due Dates

Capstone Project Stages	Type of Submission	Format	Due Date
Milestone	Low code	.pdf	Apr 27, 2026
	Full code	.html	
Final	Low code	.pdf	May 4, 2026
	Full code	.html	
Live Presentation Slide Deck	Low code	.pdf / .pptx / .ppt	
	Full code		
Live Presentation			A 15-minute slot will be allocated to each learner on either May 9 or May 10, 2026.

Capstone Project Objectives

MIT-PE Applied AI & Data Science Program: January 2026							
Course	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Week 12 Capstone Project	20-Apr-2026	21-Apr-2026	22-Apr-2026	23-Apr-2026	24-Apr-2026	25-Apr-2026	
	Business Applications of Generative AI Quiz Assessment deadline	Capstone Project: Milestone Submission links open				Capstone Project: Milestone Submission Q&A Session	
Week 13 Capstone Project: Milestone Submission Week	27-Apr-2026	28-Apr-2026	29-Apr-2026	30-Apr-2026	1-May-2026	2-May-2026	
	Capstone Project: Milestone Submission deadline	Capstone Project: Final Submission & Live Presentation Slide deck submission links open				Capstone Project: Final Submission Q&A Session & Score release: Capstone Project - Milestone Submission	
Week 14 Capstone Project: Live Presentation Week	4-May-2026	5-May-2026	6-May-2026	7-May-2026	8-May-2026	9-May-2026	
	Capstone Project: Final Submission and Live Presentation Slide Deck submission deadline	Tentative Live Presentation rosters to be shared via email		Final Live Presentation rosters to be shared		Capstone Project: Live Presentation Day	

Any Questions ?

For any further questions/queries, please reach out to us at office.aaidsp.mit@mygreatlearning.com or your designated Program Manager